

Intermediate Report

Preamble: This document is a guideline for the intermediate report to be submitted under the “Introduction to Research” curricular unit. It contains the typical content expected. It is important to note that the submitted file must be of pdf type, any other file format will not be accepted.

The report must be exactly five pages long, but the last page does not need to be filled out completely. The sections presented next are sufficient, but you are free to use more (or less). The text should preferably be written in English, although it can be written in Portuguese, but if agreed with your advisor.

Use one to three references in the report. The references must be cited in the main text.

Consider the following along the writing. These different aspects will be checked during grading.

1. Take care about your writing style.
2. Be coherent with notation along the text.
3. Figure and table captions should be brief but self-contained, i.e., reading the captions should be sufficient to understand what is being presented.
4. Aesthetics should not be neglected. A clean but elegant document is always more pleasant to read.
5. Be careful when using material that is not yours. Always give credit to the original author(s).

The remainder of this guide includes the following sections:

1. A report template with detailed descriptions of the required content.
2. A marking guide that outlines the relative weight of each component in the final grade.

Template of the Report (Issued in a separate word file. A Latex basic template is also available)

Title

Author name

1 Introduction

In this section you should detail the scientific or engineering area where your work is contextualized and state the problem, or question, on which you will develop a solution during your dissertation. Discuss about the proposal and the motivation of your work and address the possible applications and positive implications of solving your problem. In short terms, present:

- The context and topic of the work.
- The motivation that shows the importance and relevance of the work to be developed.
- State the problem and the importance of solving it.

2 Background (*this section name is illustrative; you are free to choose a name that you feel to be better suited*)

Use this section to help the reader (possibly an engineer that is not an expert in the field) to better understand the problem for which a solution will be seek during the dissertation. Present some theoretical aspects or fundamental knowledge that is relevant to understand the problem within the scientific or engineering area where your work is contextualized. Keep the content simple, short, and as qualitative as possible. By nature, it is an informative section. Choose one to three peer reviewed papers, or any other documents from your literature review that you consider to be well representative of the area where your proposal fits. Use them to support and help you to better present the ideas. Your document must have one up to three references (but no more)! Whenever appropriate, you can and should support your text with figures and tables.

3 Conclusions (*this section name is illustrative*)

Include in this section the next steps towards the final report in I2R. Also, be sure to list the main objectives of your work, that is, what is intended to accomplish during the dissertation.

4 References

List here the references used in the report (preferably in IEEE format).

Introduction to Research Final Report – Evaluation

AW: Weight in final average calculation

Describe clearly and succinctly:

A. Introduction — AW = 5

- The context (scientific or engineering field) in which the work fits.
- The motivation for proposing a new solution / approach.
- Possible applications and positive implications of a new solution to the problem.

B. Background (or equivalent) — AW = 5

- Present the theoretical aspects or fundamental knowledge that will be required for the solution that will be proposed.

C. Conclusions — AW = 2

- The main objectives of the work.
- The next steps of the work towards the final I2R report.

Report length:

D. Number of pages — AW = 1

- The number of pages is counted from the title page to the last page of the report. (The last page does not need to be filled in completely.)

References:

E. Number of references — AW = 1

- One to three references mentioned in the text.